

Populi Automation Flow: A Kid-Friendly Guide

This document explains how Populi can automate tasks. Think of Populi as a **magic school helper**. Sometimes Populi can do things on its own, but sometimes it needs helpers like Zapier or custom code. This guide uses simple examples so anyone can understand (even a 5th grader).

1. What Populi Can Do On Its Own

If the task happens inside the Populi system, Populi can do it by itself. It's like a teacher who can handle all school tasks inside the classroom.

Task	Populi's Action
Application Submitted	Send welcome email + add To-Do for admissions staff.
Grade Posted	Notify the student by email automatically.
Student Registers	Create a task for registrar to approve enrollment.
Invoice Paid	Send receipt + notify student instantly.

2. When Populi Needs a Helper

Populi can't always talk to other apps (like Google Drive, QuickBooks, Mailchimp). In that case, Populi needs a helper. Helpers can be small robots (Zapier) or strong robots (custom code).

Goal	Why Populi Can't Do It	Helper Needed
Send YouTube Live link to all students	No YouTube/SMS integration	Zapier robot
Add donor to Mailchimp	No direct link to Mailchimp	Zapier or custom code
Log tuition in QuickBooks	No QuickBooks sync	Custom code (API)
Add Google Form survey to student record	No Google Forms connection	Zapier or API helper

3. Flowchart: Who Should Do the Work?

Here is a simple decision map. Just follow the arrows to know if Populi, Zapier, or Custom Code should be used.

Task happens → Is the task only inside Populi? YES → Populi does it (built-in). NO → Is it a small outside job? YES → Use Zapier robot (ready-made helper). NO → Use Custom Code (strong helper robot).

4. Easy Analogy

Think of it like a school: - **Populi = The Teacher** → Handles all classwork inside the classroom. - **Zapier = A Ready-Made Robot** → Helps with small jobs outside (sending links, moving data). - **Custom Code = A Strong Robot Built by You** → Handles big jobs that need lots of rules and power.

5. Final Recommendation

1. Use Populi's automations for simple, inside tasks (emails, grades, attendance).
2. Use Zapier for small connections (forms, donor emails, notifications).
3. Use custom code for large, mission-critical integrations (finance, CRM sync, external systems).